brainchild as his life's work and was so obsessed that he was willing to sell the idea to anyone who would pay for it and bring it to fruition. Political or moral considerations were of no interest to him at all. When the paths of these two eccentrics— Saddam and the Canadian scientist—crossed, the project began to take shape, despite attempts by many to dissuade the scientist from getting involved. This project, too, never bore fruit.

The Iran-Iraq War ended toward the end of the 1980s. Iran emerged from the war in an inferior position, licking its wounds and trying to draw lessons. Saddam Hussein emerged from the eight-yearlong war thumping his chest, continued to develop his nonconventional capabilities and make threats against Israel, and prepared for his next military adventure—the invasion of Kuwait. On the global stage, the winds of change were blowing and bringing about the end of the Cold War era and the collapse of the Soviet Union. The Berlin Wall was destroyed on November 9, 1989.

A visit by Defense Minister Moshe ("Misha") Arens to Washington was set for the end of July 1990. It was agreed between the two sides that during this visit top US political and intelligence officials would be presented with the Israeli intelligence community's view of the Iraqi nonconventional threat. It should be noted here that in the systems regulating the exchange of intelligence between the American and Israeli communities, there were clear rules that were dictated by the Americans. They refrained from sharing intelligence with us about countries that were friends of the United States and hostile to Israel, and they were very stingy with regard to the intelligence they would share with us regarding nonconventional weapons, and especially on the nuclear issue. The Israeli defense minister's visit to Washington and the winds of war that were blowing in the lead-up to the First Gulf War created the conditions whereby the Americans were open to hearing from us how we saw the Iraqi threat. For this purpose, a special joint effort was made by MI and the Mossad, and a "white paper" was prepared, compiling a detailed intelligence picture for presentation to the Americans.

Since the Mossad was the leader on the issue of nonconventional weapons within the intelligence community, we were invited to join the defense minister's delegation, which also included Amnon Lipkin-Shahak, the head of Military Intelligence at the time; David Ivri, then-director general of the defense ministry; and others whom I cannot recall, and for this I ask their forgiveness. The Mossad was represented by Shlomo, head